

Education

University of California, Los Angeles
B.A. Applied Linguistics (hons.), 2021-2025

Research Experience

Language and Cognition Lab, Department of Psychology, Stanford University
Principal Investigator: Michael Frank
Research Coordinator, September 2026–present

- Funded by the Stanford Institute for Research in the Social Sciences predoctoral training program

Speech and Cognitive Development Lab, Department of Linguistics, UCLA
Principal Investigator: Meg Cychosz
Research Assistant, September 2023–June 2025

- Lead eye-tracking data collection with children aged 3 to 5 for studies concerning language development in children with cochlear implants
- Assisted in fNIRS data collection with infants
- Administered and scored vocabulary and articulation assessments (PPVT, GFTA, CTOPP) and hearing screenings to preschoolers

Department of Psychology, UCLA
Principal Investigator: Lindy Comstock
Research Assistant, January–June 2023

- Completed EEG data collection with adult participants

Work Experience

Fulbright English Teaching Assistant, August 2025–June 2026
Chenggong Elementary School, Xipan Elementary School, and Wanxing Junior High School, Changhua County, Taiwan

- Planned and co-taught 12 English lessons per week with five local English teachers
- Planned and implemented pen pal letter exchange between elementary English as a second language students in Modesto, California and fifth and sixth grade students in Taiwan

Circulation Desk Assistant at UCLA Law Library, September 2023–February 2025

ASUCLA Student Supervisor at Northern Lights Café, September 2022–June 2023

Awards & Honors

Fulbright Taiwan (Foundation for Scholarly Exchange), English Teaching Assistant Award, 2025-2026

UCLA Linguistics Departmental Highest Honors, June 2025

UCLA Linguistics Undergraduate Research Award, April 2025
\$1,350 in support of conference travel

UCLA Linguistics Undergraduate Research Award, April 2025
\$900 in support of conference travel

Undergraduate Research Fellows Program, UCLA, Winter 2025
\$3,000 scholarship & participation in research practicum course

Presentations

“How does speech input impact children's phonological processing skills?”
Emma Montilla, Arjun Pawar, & Meg Cychosz, at *Boston University Conference on Language Development*, November 8th, 2025 (presentation)

“How children learn phonological processing skills: an argument for the syllable”
Emma Montilla, Arjun Pawar, & Meg Cychosz, at *UCLA Undergraduate Research Week* (recorded talk, May 2025)

“A systematic review and meta-analysis of the development of coarticulation in child speech” Atlas Boulom, Coralie Cram, Nicholas Guymon, John McGahay, Zachary Metzler, **Emma Montilla**, Vishwas Shetty, Jian-Leat Siah, & Meg Cychosz at the *188th Meeting of the Acoustical Society of America*, May 22nd 2025 (poster)

“Musical Multilingualism: Constraints and Creativity in Spanish-English Bilingual Songwriting” Renee Rubanowitz, **Emma Montilla**, Cia Evangelino, Saffiya Haque, Allie Kuo, & Daria Bahtina at *Cornell Undergraduate Linguistics Conference*, April 27th 2025 (poster)

“Community-oriented psycholinguistics: a holistic approach” **Emma Montilla**, Amy Martinez, Sonia Patrizi, Christina Blomquist, Nicole Nguyen, & Meg Cychosz at the *Conference on Human Sentence Processing*, University of Maryland, College Park, March 28th & 29th 2025 (poster)

“Bilingual language development in children with hearing loss”, presented by Meg Cychosz, with **Emma Montilla**, Julianna Gross, Amy Martinez, & Sonia Patrizi at *Building Connections* (talk at 3-day virtual retreat for families of children with hearing loss), April 2024

Issues in Bilingualism panel moderator, *University of California Undergraduate Conference on Slavic and East/Central European Studies*, April 2024

Volunteering

Childcare volunteer, John Tracy Center (Los Angeles education and treatment center for preschoolers with hearing loss), January–June 2025

Language exchange partner (Mandarin-English), UCLA Dashew Center for International Students, 2023–2024

Other Education

Continuing science education at Modesto Junior College, Spring 2026–present
Study abroad at National Taiwan University, Summer 2023

Languages

English, Mandarin Chinese

Skills

Hardware: EyeLink 1000 (eye-tracking), EEG
Software: Qualtrics, Praat, REDCap, basic Python, basic R
Microsoft Excel, PowerPoint, and Word

Relevant Coursework

Experimental Methods in Psychology (Stanford, audited graduate course)

Speech Production (UCLA, graduate course)

Applied Phonetics and Experimental Phonetics

Language Development, Bilingualism, Heritage Language Linguistics